LA CUCINA ITALIANA - SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | REGIONAL ITALIAN RECIPES

Sardinian Fregola with Seafood or Summer Vegetables in Saffron-Tomato Brodo

Discover Sardinian Fregola with Seafood or Vegetables-nutty toasted pearl pasta simmered in a golden saffron, white wine, and cherry tomato brodo (+ free PDF).

Prep: 15 mins | Cook: 18 mins | Total: 33 mins | Yield: 4 servings | Calories: 470 kcal

INGREDIENTS CHECKLIST

[ ] 320g (11 oz) Toasted Sardinian Fregola Sarda (Medium Pearls)
[ ] 800g clams (or 3 cups vegetables) Fresh Manila Clams or Mussels (OR Diced Zucchini & Chickpeas)
[ ] 250g Halved Datterini or Cherry Tomatoes
[ ] 120ml wine, 750ml seafood or vegetable broth Dry Vermentino White Wine & Warm Broth
[ ] 1 generous pinch Saffron Threads (bloomed in 2 tbsp warm broth)
[ ] 3 cloves garlic, 1/2 cup parsley, 3 tbsp EVOO Fresh Garlic, Parsley, Chili Flakes & Olive Oil

STEP-BY-STEP CULINARY INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Steam Open Clams (or Sear Vegetables) [5 mins]

In a wide saut pan, heat 2 tablespoons olive oil with 1 smashed garlic clove and parsley stems. Add clams and white wine, cover for 4 minutes until shells pop open, then transfer clams to a bowl and strain the savory wine juices.

Step 2: Toast Fregola with Tomatoes & Saffron [3 mins]

In the same pan, saut remaining minced garlic and halved cherry tomatoes for 2 minutes. Stir in dry toasted Fregola pearls for 1 minute to coat in oil.

Step 3: Simmer Risotto-Style in Saffron Brodo [13 mins]

Pour in the strained clam wine juices, bloomed saffron, and warm broth. Simmer uncovered for 12 to 14 minutes until the fregola is tender and surrounded by a spoonable golden brodo.

Step 4: Return Seafood/Vegetables & Garnish

Fold the clams (or roasted zucchini and blossoms) back into the pot for 1 minute to warm through. Shower with chopped parsley, lemon zest, and extra virgin olive oil.

CHEF'S PRO TIPS & STORAGE

* Fregola Sarda is rolled from semolina dough and oven-toasted in Sardinia, giving it a nutty flavor that absorbs saffron broth like risotto without constant stirring.
* For a 100% plant-based Sardinian dinner ('Fregola con Verdure'), replace the clams with diced zucchini, asparagus tips, and a can of chickpeas.